

Lost in the Maze

The attacks were the failure of a multitude of security agencies. The answer is to create a single hub for various intelligence inputs

NSA



M.K. NARAYANAN

The NSA is the single-point security adviser to the PM. Most of the intelligence agencies including R&AW, IB and NTRO report to him.

R&AW

India's external intelligence agency. Also has the Aviation Research Centre (ARC).



ASHOK CHATURVEDI

IB

Internal security organisation. Collects information on terrorist organisations.



P.C. HALDAR

NTRO

National Technical Research Organisation collects tech-int from satellites and UAVs



K.V.S.S. PRASAD RAO

NSC

National Security Council is the apex agency for national security which functions as the NSA's secretariat. It has three deputy NSAs and a three-tier body.

JIC

Headed by one of the three deputy NSAs. Analyses intelligence from the various intelligence agencies. Makes up the NSC along with the Strategic Policy Group and NSAB.

NSAB

Multi-disciplinary body set up to provide the NSC with long term analysis to the NSC. Comprises retired officials and domain specialists.

DIA

Defence Intelligence Agency collates inputs from the army, air force and naval intelligence to reduce the armed force's dependence on central agencies.

DRI

Department of Revenue Intelligence functions under the Central Board of Excise and Customs under the Finance Ministry. Tracks violation of fiscal laws.

STATE INT BUREAUS

Eyes and ears of the state government and police on the ground but are understaffed, under funded and heavily politicised. The weakest link in the chain.



secretarial staff. The field strength is 3,500, of which a large number are engaged in political intelligence. In a country with 1.2 billion people, the organisation is likely to be near ineffectual.

A senior IB official said the system needs to be upgraded at the human, technical and operational levels. Money to the tune of Rs 1,000 crore needs to be invested to strengthen the intelligence-gathering set-up. While the terrorists keep changing their modus operandi and technology, intelligence officials have remained boxed in with their old bureaucratised way of thinking.

State intelligence wings across the country, used largely to gather political intelligence for ruling parties, continued to operate in the same time-warped that bred chronic blindness. This translated into ignoring warnings. A committee to strengthen intelligence in the states, of which DGPs of Maharashtra, Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Assam and Uttar Pradesh are members, has not met even once in the past two years. Suresh Arora, intelligence chief of Punjab Police,

INDIA RUNS AN ALPHABETICAL SOUP OF INTELLIGENCE AGENCIES, OFTEN WORKING AT CROSS-PURPOSES.